

SPACE OPERA

MASTER PROMPT PACK

Adult Fiction Line

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From Galactic Concept to Published Novel

22 Copy-Paste Prompts for Any AI

Empires, fleets and a thousand worlds - and one crew small enough to slip between them and change everything.

Star empires • Found family crews • Fleet battles • First contact • Succession • Rebellion

Jump drives • Generation ships • Alien civilisations • Dynasties • Long wars • Impossible odds

Subgenres: Military Space Opera, Crew/Found-Family Adventure, Political & Dynastic, New Space Opera (hard-leaning), Planetary Romance, First Contact Epic, Post-Human & Ascension, Space Western

Works with ChatGPT • Claude • Gemini • Copilot • Any LLM

Royalti Studios

The galaxy is the stage. The book is about the people small enough to be crushed by it - and who are not.

How to Use This Pack

Space opera is the genre of enormous stakes told through people you would follow anywhere. It fails in two directions: too small, and it is a ship story with a galaxy painted behind it; too large, and it is a history book nobody cries at. This pack keeps both ends honest. You will build travel rules that generate politics, factions with real economies, a cast whose personal wants are wired into the galactic ones, and a structure that can carry a war without losing a crew. Work the prompts in order, save every output in one document, and by Prompt 22 that document is your series bible - which this genre will absolutely require of you.

Phase 1 (Prompts 1-3) - Set the scale. Find the operatic premise, calibrate the distance between the intimate and the galactic, and lock your reader promise and shelf position.

Phase 2 (Prompts 4-8) - Build the galaxy. Travel rules as political geography, the great powers and their economies, species and cultures, the technology of war and trade, and the deep history that everyone is still arguing about.

Phase 3 (Prompts 9-12) - Forge the cast. A protagonist standing at a hinge of history, the crew or command ensemble, the antagonist power with a legitimate claim, and the loyalty web that will be tested by orders.

Phase 4 (Prompts 13-16) - Architect the story. The incident that starts the war, the full beat sheet, a set-piece and fleet-battle generator, and a system for braiding multiple point-of-view threads without losing the reader.

Phase 5 (Prompts 17-19) - Write the book. Chapter outline with hooks, an opening that establishes scale through one person, and a batch-drafting engine that holds voice, scale and continuity.

Phase 6 (Prompts 20-22) - Polish, publish, expand. A scale and continuity audit, a wonder-and-voice pass, and the blurb, metadata and multi-book series architecture kit.

What you need: Any AI chat tool and a place to save your outputs between prompts. Brackets like [THIS] are placeholders - replace them with your content from previous prompts.

Skip what doesn't apply - the system is modular. Writing a single-ship found-family adventure? Prompt 15's fleet-battle section becomes a boarding-action section, and Prompt 16 is a light pass. Writing dynastic political opera with one viewpoint? Prompt 16 becomes a court-intrigue thread map.

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Quick Reference Card

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Space Opera Rules Cheat Sheet

WHAT MAKES IT SPACE OPERA:

- ✓ Galactic stakes felt through one specific person's want - the war matters because she does
- ✓ Travel rules that create political geography: what is close, what is unreachable, what a message costs in time
- ✓ Factions with economies, succession problems and internal politics, not costumes and flags
- ✓ A crew or command group with real interdependence, competence and unresolved history
- ✓ Wonder delivered as physical experience - the size of the thing, the sound of it, what it does to a human body
- ✓ An antagonist power whose claim is legitimate enough that a reasonable person could serve it
- ✓ Consequences that scale: a decision on a bridge that shows up as a burnt city three chapters later
- ✓ Alien cultures built from a different premise about life, not humans with foreheads and a proper noun
- ✓ A war whose logistics exist - fuel, yards, crews, supply lines, casualty replacement
- ✓ An ending that resolves the personal story completely, even when the galactic one continues

WHAT KILLS SPACE OPERA:

- ✗ Infodump chapters where a character explains the political situation to someone who lives in it
- ✗ A galaxy of one-note planets: the desert planet, the ice planet, the trade planet
- ✗ Fleet battles with no geometry, no logistics and no cost - ships as counters rather than places
- ✗ Aliens who are humans with a single exaggerated trait and no material culture
- ✗ A protagonist who happens to be present at every historically significant event
- ✗ Stakes inflation, where each act must threaten more worlds until the reader stops feeling any of it
- ✗ Faster-than-light rules that change whenever the plot needs someone to arrive on time
- ✗ Empires with no economy - no taxation, no food, no shipyards, no reason anyone obeys
- ✗ Named characters dying in job lots to signal seriousness, with no one grieving anyone
- ✗ A finale resolved by a superweapon or a single unrepeatable technology nobody thought to use earlier

SPACE OPERA VOICE ESSENTIALS:

- ✓ Ground the enormous in the bodily - acceleration, cold, recycled air, the smell of a hangar deck
- ✓ Scale by comparison, not by numbers - one image the reader can hold beats six digits
- ✓ Competence register: professionals speak in procedure and shorthand, and the reader keeps up
- ✓ Let awe be rare; three genuinely astonishing moments outperform constant grandeur
- ✓ Distinct faction voices - court speech, service jargon, spacer creole, alien syntax
- ✓ Interiority under command pressure: what it costs to give an order, and who the character is not saying it to
- ✓ Concrete logistics in dialogue - fuel states, transit times, casualty numbers spoken plainly
- ✓ Keep sentences short in vacuum and combat; open them up planetside and in council chambers

THE SPACE OPERA STRUCTURE FORMULA:

The Small Life (we meet the protagonist inside a specific, ordinary duty) -> The Incident (something happens that the great powers cannot ignore) -> Conscription (they are pulled into the machine, willing or not) -> The Crew or Command Forms -> First Engagement (the cost of this war made physical) -> The Wider Picture (the reader learns what is really being fought over) -> The Order That Cannot Be Obeyed -> Betrayal or Political Reversal -> Catastrophic Loss (a world, a fleet, a friend) -> The Hinge (a choice only this person can make) -> The Decisive Engagement on the Enemy's Terms -> A Settled Personal Story, an Unsettled Galaxy -> The Cost, Counted

READER EXPECTATIONS:

Space opera readers want two things at once and will not accept either alone: the awe of scale and the intimacy of a crew they would follow into a sequel. They expect the politics to hold up under thought - factions that want things for reasons, wars with supply lines, travel rules that stay fixed - and they expect at least three moments of genuine wonder. They will tolerate a large cast if every viewpoint is distinct and earns its pages. They will not forgive stakes inflation, a superweapon ending, or a galaxy where nobody eats. Above all they expect the personal story to land: the war can continue past the last page, but the character's question must be answered.

PHASE 1: SET THE SCALE

Space opera lives or dies on the distance between the biggest thing in your book and the smallest. These three prompts find your operatic premise, calibrate that distance deliberately, and turn both into a market position you can steer by.

PROMPT 1 of 22

The Operatic Premise

This genre needs a premise big enough to justify a galaxy and specific enough to fit in one person's hands. This prompt finds both halves and welds them together.

> COPY THIS PROMPT:

You are a developmental editor who has worked on space opera and epic science fiction for twenty years.

My rough idea is: [DESCRIBE IN 2-4 SENTENCES - a situation, an image, a ship, a war, whatever I have]

Do the following:

1. THE GALACTIC QUESTION: name the large-scale question my book is really about - succession, secession, first contact, resource control, an ideology, a returning threat, the ethics of a technology. State it in one sentence.
2. THE PERSONAL QUESTION: name the intimate question that will carry it - belonging, loyalty versus conscience, revenge, duty versus love, the price of command, whether one person's life matters at this scale. One sentence.
3. THE WELD: describe in a paragraph how these two questions are the same question seen at different magnifications. If they are not, tell me plainly and offer me two personal questions that would weld properly to my galactic one.
4. THE HINGE: identify the moment where one specific person's decision changes the galactic outcome, and give me a plausible reason they are the one standing there - position, access, knowledge, or accident. Never 'chosen'.
5. THE OPENING IMAGE AND THE CLOSING IMAGE: propose both, and show me how the second answers the first.
6. THE CHEAP VERSION: describe the generic version of my idea so I know exactly what to avoid.

End by asking me which of the two questions I care about more, because that answer decides whether this is a war story with a heart or a character story with a war in it.

Pro Tip: If your hinge requires your protagonist to be uniquely special, replace it with a hinge that requires them to be uniquely placed. Position is more believable than destiny and produces better plots.

PROMPT 2 of 22

Scale Calibration

How wide is your galaxy, how many viewpoints, how long a timespan? This prompt sets those dials on purpose instead of letting them drift upward during drafting.

✂️ **COPY THIS PROMPT:**

You are a structural editor specialising in large-canvas science fiction.

My galactic and personal questions: [PASTE FROM PROMPT 1]

Target length: [E.G. 120,000 WORDS] and planned series length: [E.G. TRILOGY]

Calibrate my scale:

1. THE CANVAS: how many inhabited systems does my story actually need? Give me a number and a justification. Then name the 5-7 locations that will carry the whole book, because readers remember places they revisit.
2. THE VIEWPOINT COUNT: recommend a number of point-of-view characters for my length and premise, with the trade-offs. Warn me about the specific failure mode of the count I am probably tempted by.
3. THE TIMESPAN: over what period does book one take place - weeks, months, years? Tell me what each choice does to the emotional continuity of a crew.
4. THE SUBGENRE PLACEMENT: name my primary subgenre and two secondaries from: military space opera, crew/found-family adventure, political and dynastic, new space opera (hard-leaning), planetary romance, first contact epic, post-human and ascension, space western. Justify each.
5. THE RIGOUR DIAL: from 1 to 10, how much physics does my book owe the reader? Say what my chosen number obligates me to handle carefully and what it lets me wave past.
6. THE STAKES CEILING: state now, in one sentence, the largest thing that will ever be threatened in this series - and commit to it, so I never have to inflate past it.

End by asking me which single location I want the reader to feel homesick for, because that place needs to appear in the first three chapters.

Pro Tip: Setting the stakes ceiling early is the most valuable thing in this prompt. Books that escalate to 'the whole galaxy' by act two have nowhere to go, and readers stop feeling anything the moment the numbers exceed imagination.

PROMPT 3 of 22

Reader Promise & Shelf Position

This prompt turns premise and scale into a market stance - who it is for, what it promises, and which promises are load-bearing.

✂️ **COPY THIS PROMPT:**

You are a publishing strategist positioning science fiction for adult readers.

My premise: [PASTE FROM PROMPT 1]

My scale calibration and subgenres: [PASTE FROM PROMPT 2]

Do the following:

1. Write my READER PROMISE in one paragraph, in the second person ('You will feel...').
2. Identify the 3 reader appeals I am leading with, from: found family, military competence and tactics, political intrigue, sense of wonder and exploration, first contact and xenology, romance across a divide, revenge, big ideas about consciousness or civilisation.
3. Write 3 one-line pitches in different registers: one epic and sweeping, one that leads with the crew, one that leads with the central moral problem.
4. Name my ideal reader in a paragraph - what they have read recently, and what they are hungry for that the market underserves.
5. List the 4 promises I must NOT break, and write the one-star review each breach would generate in the reviewer's own words.
6. Tell me which element of my concept is most commercially distinctive, and how to get it onto the page within the first three chapters.

End by asking me which pitch sounds most like the book I actually want to write, since that governs how much page time goes to war versus to people.

Pro Tip: In this genre the crew pitch almost always outsells the epic pitch. Readers commit to people and stay for empires - write the sweeping version for your own clarity and lead with the human one everywhere it counts.

PHASE 2: BUILD THE GALAXY

Space opera worldbuilding is not decoration - it is the source of your plot. Travel rules make political geography. Economies make wars. History makes grievance. These five prompts build a galaxy that generates conflict on its own, so you never have to force one.

PROMPT 4 of 22

Travel Rules as Political Geography

How people cross space determines who rules whom, what a message costs, and where power concentrates. This prompt sets the rules once, permanently, and derives your map's politics from them.

✂️ **COPY THIS PROMPT:**

You are a worldbuilding consultant who designs travel systems for science fiction and then derives their political consequences.

My rigour dial and canvas size: [PASTE FROM PROMPT 2]

My premise: [FROM PROMPT 1]

Build my TRAVEL SYSTEM:

1. THE MECHANISM: how ships cross interstellar distance. Describe it in plain language in four sentences. Choose a system that suits my rigour dial - jump points, warp, relativistic slower-than-light, gates, or something else.
2. THE CONSTRAINTS: state 5 hard rules I can never break - what it costs, how long it takes, what it requires, where it cannot be done, and what it does to the people aboard. Write them as rules, not as flavour.
3. COMMUNICATION: how fast does information travel compared to ships? This single answer determines whether my galaxy has central authority or de facto independence. Spell out the political consequence explicitly.
4. THE CHOKEPOINTS: given the mechanism, which systems are strategically decisive and why? Name 4 and describe who holds each one now.
5. THE FRONTIER: where does control genuinely stop, and what lives past it?
6. THE TRAVEL EXPERIENCE: what a transit actually feels like for a passenger - duration, sensation, danger, boredom, ritual. Give me one paragraph I could adapt into prose.
7. THE MAP CONSEQUENCE: summarise in a paragraph how these rules shape who can rule whom, where rebellion is feasible, and why the war in my book is fought where it is.

End by asking me whether any faction has a travel advantage the others do not, because that asymmetry is worth an entire trilogy.

Pro Tip: Item 3 is the most consequential decision in your whole galaxy. Messages slower than ships gives you feudal governors and honest miscommunication; messages faster gives you surveillance, central command and a very different kind of story.

PROMPT 5 of 22

Powers, Factions and Their Economies

Empires need food, fuel, shipyards and a reason people obey. This prompt builds your great powers as functioning entities with pressures your plot can exploit.

> **COPY THIS PROMPT:**

You are a political economist consulting on interstellar polities.

My travel rules and their political consequences: [PASTE FROM PROMPT 4]

My galactic question: [FROM PROMPT 1]

Build my POWERS:

1. THE MAJORS: 3-4 great powers. For each - name, form of government, how it legitimises itself, its core economic base, its military doctrine, and the internal problem it is currently managing badly.
2. THE MINORS: 3 smaller entities that matter - a corporate concern, a religious

order, a trade league, an independent world, a nomad fleet, a criminal syndicate. What each one controls that the majors need.

3. THE ECONOMY: what actually moves between systems given my travel constraints, and what does not because it is uneconomic to ship. Name the 3 commodities worth fighting over and why.
4. WHO EATS: how each major power feeds itself, and what happens to a system whose supply line is cut. This is where sieges and blockades get their teeth.
5. THE SUCCESSION PROBLEM: for the power most central to my plot, describe how authority transfers and what is currently going wrong with that process.
6. THE FLASHPOINT: the current dispute between two powers - what it is over, who is escalating, and what each side would accept. My plot lives here.
7. THE FACTION VOICES: for each major, 3 phrases and one piece of etiquette that identifies a citizen instantly in dialogue.

End by asking me which power my protagonist was born under, and whether they still believe in it.

Pro Tip: Give every power a genuine virtue and a genuine crime. Readers who can construct an argument for the enemy will argue about your book online for years, which is the best marketing there is.

PROMPT 6 of 22

Species, Cultures and Xenology

Aliens built from a different premise about life are the genre's greatest pleasure. This prompt builds yours from biology upward, or builds divergent human cultures if your book has no aliens.

✂ COPY THIS PROMPT:

You are a xenologist and cultural anthropologist consulting on science fiction. If my book has no non-human species, apply every step below to divergent human cultures shaped by centuries of separation instead.

My galaxy and powers: [PASTE FROM PROMPTS 4-5]

My premise: [FROM PROMPT 1]

Build my PEOPLES. For each of 2-3 species or cultures:

1. THE PREMISE: the single biological, environmental or historical fact everything else follows from - how they reproduce, how they sense the world, how long they live, what their homeworld demanded of them.
2. THE CONSEQUENCES: 6 downstream traits - social structure, attitude to death, concept of property, family arrangement, art, what they find disgusting - each traceable to the premise in item 1.
3. THE MATERIAL CULTURE: what their ships, buildings, clothing and tools look like and why, given their bodies and their premise.
4. THE MISUNDERSTANDING: the specific thing humans consistently get wrong about them, and the thing they consistently get wrong about humans. Both should be plot-usable.
5. THE LANGUAGE SHAPE: how their speech works differently - tense, register, evidential markers, silence, scent, whatever fits - and how I render that in

English without resorting to broken grammar.

6. THE INTERNAL DIVERSITY: 3 factions or subcultures within them, so they are never a monolith.

7. ONE SCENE SEED: a situation where their premise creates conflict with my protagonist that neither party is being unreasonable about.

End by asking me which of these peoples my protagonist has a personal history with, so the xenology can arrive as relationship rather than as lecture.

Pro Tip: Item 4 is where your best scenes come from. Mutual, sympathetic misunderstanding generates more story than hostility ever will, because the reader can see both sides being reasonable and heading for a wall.

PROMPT 7 of 22

Ships, War and the Technology of Power

This prompt builds the hardware and the doctrine - what ships are, how battles work, what war costs, and what technology means politically.

✂ **COPY THIS PROMPT:**

You are a military and technology consultant for science fiction, working strictly within the travel constraints already established.

My travel rules and constraints: [PASTE FROM PROMPT 4]

My powers and their doctrines: [PASTE FROM PROMPT 5]

My rigour dial: [FROM PROMPT 2]

Build my MILITARY AND TECHNOLOGICAL LAYER:

1. THE SHIP CLASSES: 5 classes from smallest to largest, with crew size, role, endurance, and what each one cannot do. Include what it costs and how long it takes to build one.

2. LIFE ABOARD: the daily reality on my protagonist's ship - watches, food, gravity or its absence, noise, smell, privacy, what the crew complains about.

3. COMBAT DOCTRINE: how engagements actually work given my travel and communication rules - ranges, detection, timescale, what wins. State whether battles are decided in seconds or days, because it changes every action scene I write.

4. THE COST OF WAR: casualty rates, how ships are lost, what happens to survivors, replacement times for hulls and trained crews, and what a long war does to a society's economy.

5. THE FIVE TECHNOLOGIES THAT MATTER: for each - what it does, who has it, what it costs, and its political consequence. Include at least one that is uncomfortable rather than cool.

6. THE LIMITS: 5 things technology cannot do in my galaxy. This list is what makes my plot difficult and therefore possible.

7. THE PERSONAL SCALE: what a single soldier, pilot or spacer carries, wears and relies on. Wonder is delivered at this scale, not at fleet scale.

End by asking me whether my protagonist has ever been in a real engagement, because a veteran and a novice require completely different opening chapters.

Pro Tip: Decide item 3 before you write a single battle. A genre where engagements take days of manoeuvring produces tension and dread; one where they take seconds produces terror and aftermath. Mixing them accidentally is the most common structural failure in the genre.

PROMPT 8 of 22

Deep History and the Grievance Map

Space opera runs on old wounds. This prompt builds the history everyone is still arguing about, the myth that is half-true, and the grievances your plot will detonate.

✂ **COPY THIS PROMPT:**

You are a historian consulting on the deep past of a fictional galaxy.

My powers and peoples: [PASTE FROM PROMPTS 5-6]

My galactic question: [FROM PROMPT 1]

Build my HISTORY:

1. THE ERAS: 4 named periods from earliest to present, one paragraph each, ending in the present day of my story.
2. THE FOUNDING CRIME: the event at the root of the current order that its beneficiaries have reframed as something noble. Give me both the official version and what actually happened.
3. THE GRIEVANCE MAP: for each major power and people, what they will not forgive, whom they blame, and what they teach their children about it.
4. THE HALF-TRUE MYTH: a widely believed story about the past that is partly accurate. Say which part is true, and how my plot can turn on the difference.
5. THE DEEP PAST: is there an older civilisation, a ruin, a precursor, an unexplained artefact? If it fits my premise, describe it and state clearly what it is NOT going to do, so I never resolve my plot with it.
6. THE LIVING MEMORY: which characters in my story were alive for which events, and what that does to how they behave now.
7. THE ANNIVERSARY: a commemoration, holiday or ritual observed differently by different powers - an excellent scene setting for confrontation.

End by asking me whether the truth about the founding crime gets out during my book, because that decision shapes the whole third act.

Pro Tip: Item 5's second half is a discipline, not a limitation. Precursor technology that can solve your climax will always tempt you in draft two - writing down now that it cannot is how you protect your ending.

PHASE 3: FORGE THE CAST

The galaxy is built. Now the people who will make the reader care about it. These four prompts give you a protagonist standing where history bends, an ensemble with real interdependence, an antagonist power with a legitimate claim, and the loyalty web that command will eventually break.

PROMPT 9 of 22

The Protagonist at the Hinge

This prompt builds a protagonist whose personal want is wired directly into the galactic question, and who is positioned - not chosen - to matter.

✂ COPY THIS PROMPT:

You are a character-development editor for epic science fiction.

My galactic and personal questions, and my hinge: [PASTE FROM PROMPT 1]

My powers and the flashpoint: [PASTE FROM PROMPT 5]

My rough protagonist idea: [DESCRIBE, or say 'you choose']

Build my PROTAGONIST:

1. THE BASICS: name, age, origin world, current duty or role, and the exact position that places them near the hinge.
2. THE COMPETENCE: what they are professionally excellent at, described precisely enough that I can write them working. Readers of this genre come for competence - make it specific.
3. THE WANT AND THE NEED: what they are pursuing at the start, and what the book will prove they actually need. State how the galactic question forces the gap open.
4. THE LOYALTY: what or whom they serve at the start - a power, a ship, a family, an oath, a debt - and the exact conditions under which that loyalty would break.
5. THE PRIVATE COST: what serving has already taken from them, named specifically.
6. THE ARC: 5 stages from their opening loyalty to their final position, each triggered by an external event rather than a change of heart. At least one stage must be a step backwards.
7. THE THING THEY CANNOT DO: the order they will refuse, the line that defines them. Act three will put them on it.
8. THE SMALL LIFE: three ordinary, non-heroic details - a habit, a possession, a private pleasure - that will make the scale land when it arrives.

End by asking me whether my protagonist survives the series, because in this genre that answer changes what I plant in book one.

Pro Tip: Item 8 does more work than any other. The reader feels a burning world through the character's ruined ordinary things - the mug, the letter, the routine. Establish them early and cheaply so they can cost you later.

PROMPT 10 of 22

The Crew or Command Ensemble

Whether it is a ship's crew, a command staff or a political household, this genre needs a group the reader would follow for four books. This prompt builds one with real interdependence and unresolved history.

✂ **COPY THIS PROMPT:**

You are an ensemble developer for character-driven science fiction.

My protagonist: [PASTE FROM PROMPT 9]

My ship classes and life aboard: [PASTE FROM PROMPT 7]

My powers and peoples: [PASTE FROM PROMPTS 5-6]

Build my ENSEMBLE of 5-7 characters:

1. For each: name, role, origin (which power or people), how long they have served together, and the competence they own outright.
2. THE INTERDEPENDENCE: what the group cannot do without each member. If two overlap, say so and tell me which to cut or differentiate.
3. THE POSITION: each member's answer to my galactic question. No two identical, and at least one should hold a view the reader will find uncomfortable.
4. THE HISTORY: 4 pieces of shared past - a mission that went wrong, a debt, a relationship that ended, a promotion someone else deserved - that can surface as friction under pressure.
5. THE FRACTURE LINES: for each member, the order or revelation that would make them break with the group.
6. THE TEXTURE: for each, one habit, one possession and one thing they say. This is how a reader tells seven people apart at speed.
7. THE ROTATION PLAN: which members carry viewpoint chapters (matching the count from Prompt 2) and which are seen only from outside, plus the reason for each choice.

Then tell me which two deaths would hurt most, and which member I am most likely to under-write.

End by asking me which crew member disagrees with my protagonist most sharply, because that person should get more page time than my instincts will give them.

Pro Tip: Give the ensemble one running, low-stakes argument - about food, a card game, a regulation, a piece of music - that recurs across the book. It is the cheapest way to make a reader feel they have lived aboard, and it becomes unbearable to reread after someone dies.

PROMPT 11 of 22

The Antagonist Power and Its Legitimate Claim

The best space opera antagonists have a case. This prompt builds the opposing power, the person who represents it, and the argument the reader will struggle to dismiss.

✂ **COPY THIS PROMPT:**

You are an editor who specialises in antagonists that readers argue about.

My powers and the flashpoint: [PASTE FROM PROMPT 5]

My grievance map and founding crime: [PASTE FROM PROMPT 8]

My protagonist and their loyalty: [PASTE FROM PROMPT 9]

Build my ANTAGONIST LAYER:

1. THE OPPOSING POWER: what it wants, in concrete terms, and the historical grievance that justifies the want. Two paragraphs.
2. THE LEGITIMATE CLAIM: state the strongest version of their case in 150-200 words. It must be strong enough that a decent person could serve them, and it should draw on the founding crime from Prompt 8.
3. THE FACE: the individual who embodies the opposition for my protagonist. Name, rank, how they rose, what they have sacrificed, how they speak, and what they are genuinely good at.
4. THE MIRROR: 3 things this person and my protagonist share, including one my protagonist would deny.
5. THE MEANS THEY EXCEED: the specific point where their legitimate claim becomes an unjustifiable act. Name it precisely, because that is where the reader's sympathy has to break.
6. THE INTERNAL OPPOSITION: someone on their side who thinks they have gone too far, and what my protagonist could offer that person.
7. THE THIRD PARTY: a power that benefits from both sides fighting, and what they are quietly doing about it.

End by asking me whether my antagonist could have been persuaded at any point in the book, and if so, who failed to do it.

Pro Tip: Write the legitimate claim at item 2 before any battle scene. Every tactical decision the opposition makes afterwards should be the act of someone who believes it, which turns your fleet engagements into arguments rather than fireworks.

PROMPT 12 of 22

Orders, Loyalty and the Relationship Web

In this genre, relationships are broken by duty rather than by malice. This prompt maps the web and designs the orders that will tear it.

> **COPY THIS PROMPT:**

You are a plot architect specialising in loyalty, command and moral pressure.

My ensemble: [PASTE FROM PROMPT 10]

My protagonist's loyalty and the thing they cannot do: [PASTE FROM PROMPT 9]

My antagonist's claim: [PASTE FROM PROMPT 11]

Build my LOYALTY STRUCTURE:

1. THE CHAIN: who gives my protagonist orders, who gives them theirs, and where

the chain becomes political rather than operational.

2. THE WEB: for each significant pair in my cast, one line on the bond and one on what would strain it.
3. THE THREE ORDERS: design three orders my protagonist receives across the book, escalating in moral difficulty. The first is obeyed with unease, the second is obeyed at a cost, the third is the one from Prompt 9 item 7. Give me the tactical justification for each, from the issuer's point of view.
4. THE DIVIDED CREW: for the third order, state where each ensemble member stands and why, using their positions from Prompt 10.
5. THE ROMANCE OR DEEP BOND: if my book has one, name the pair, what draws them, and the duty that stands between them. If not, name the friendship that carries the same weight.
6. THE BETRAYAL: one member acts against the group. Who, when, why it is defensible, and the 5 details I can plant beforehand that read innocently first time.
7. THE AFTERMATH OPTIONS: three ways the group can respond to the betrayal, and what each choice says about the book's moral position.

End by asking me whether my protagonist obeys the third order, because everything in Phase 4 is built on that answer.

Pro Tip: Make the third order tactically correct. An order that is both militarily sound and morally intolerable is the single strongest situation this genre can generate - and it is ruined the moment you make the issuer a fool.

PHASE 4: ARCHITECT THE STORY

Now the machine. These four prompts build the incident that pulls your protagonist into history, the full beat sheet, a generator for the genre's big sequences, and a system for braiding multiple viewpoints so a large canvas never loses the reader.

PROMPT 13 of 22

The Incident and the First Act

Space opera begins with a small life interrupted by something the great powers cannot ignore. This prompt designs that interruption and builds act one around it.

✂ **COPY THIS PROMPT:**

You are a story architect for epic science fiction.

My protagonist and their small life: [PASTE FROM PROMPT 9]

My flashpoint: [PASTE FROM PROMPT 5 ITEM 6]

My travel and communication rules: [PASTE FROM PROMPT 4]

Build my FIRST ACT:

1. THE ORDINARY DUTY: the opening scene - my protagonist doing their job competently, with the scale of the galaxy present only as background texture. Two paragraphs.
2. THE INCIDENT: the event that cannot be contained. Give me 4 options at increasing scale, then recommend one that fits my stakes ceiling from Prompt 2 without spending it.
3. WHY IT REACHES THEM: the specific reason this event lands on my protagonist rather than on anyone else - position, witness, possession, order, accident.
4. THE INFORMATION PROBLEM: given my communication rules, who learns what and when? Build at least one act-one complication out of the lag.
5. THE CONSCRIPTION: how my protagonist is pulled in - orders, necessity, revenge, obligation - and the moment they can no longer step back.
6. THE ACT ONE BEATS: 10-12 sequential beats from the opening image to the point of no return, one sentence each, naming who is present and what changes.
7. THE PROMISE: what act one promises the reader about the shape and scale of what follows, stated in one sentence.

End by asking me what my protagonist loses in act one from their small life, and whether they ever get it back.

Pro Tip: Spend a full chapter on the ordinary duty before the incident. Readers cannot feel a galaxy at risk until they have felt one deck plate under one pair of boots - and the chapter you are tempted to cut is the one that makes chapter thirty devastating.

PROMPT 14 of 22

The Full Beat Sheet

This prompt maps the whole novel onto the genre's spine, placing every major turn and keeping the personal and galactic threads in step.

✂ COPY THIS PROMPT:

You are a story architect building a complete beat sheet for a space opera novel.

My act one: [PASTE FROM PROMPT 13]

My ensemble and the three orders: [PASTE FROM PROMPTS 10 AND 12]

My antagonist and their claim: [PASTE FROM PROMPT 11]

My locations: [FROM PROMPT 2]

Target length: [E.G. 120,000 WORDS]

Build my BEAT SHEET across these stations. For each: 2-4 sentences, an approximate word-count position, and a note on whether the beat serves the galactic thread, the personal thread, or both:

1. The Small Life
2. The Incident
3. Conscription / Point of No Return
4. The Crew or Command Forms
5. First Engagement - the cost of this war made physical

6. The Wider Picture - the reader learns what is really being fought over
7. Midpoint: The Second Order, obeyed at a cost
8. Political Reversal - an ally becomes a problem, or a truth from Prompt 8 surfaces
9. The Betrayal from Prompt 12
10. Catastrophic Loss - a world, a fleet, or a member of the ensemble
11. The Third Order - the hinge from Prompt 1
12. The Decisive Engagement, on the enemy's terms
13. A Settled Personal Story, an Unsettled Galaxy
14. The Cost, Counted

Then: flag any beat relying on coincidence, any two beats doing the same job, any place where the galactic thread runs for more than three beats without a personal one, and any point where I exceed the stakes ceiling I set in Prompt 2.

End by asking me whether beat 13 answers the personal question from Prompt 1, because if it only resolves the war, readers will call the ending hollow.

Pro Tip: Check the alternation deliberately. The genre's most common structural failure is three or four consecutive chapters of fleets and politics with no one to be frightened for - and it is always fixable by moving a personal beat, never by adding explanation.

PROMPT 15 of 22

Set-Piece and Fleet-Battle Generator

Reusable for every large sequence: fleet actions, boarding actions, sieges, evacuations, planetary landings and council confrontations. Built for geometry, cost and consequence.

✂ **COPY THIS PROMPT:**

You are a tactical and dramatic choreographer for science fiction set pieces.

My combat doctrine and ship classes: [PASTE FROM PROMPT 7]

My travel and communication constraints: [PASTE FROM PROMPT 4]

My ensemble and their roles: [PASTE FROM PROMPT 10]

The sequence I need: [E.G. A FLEET ACTION AT A CHOKEPOINT / A BOARDING ACTION / AN EVACUATION UNDER FIRE / A SIEGE OF A STATION / A COUNCIL CONFRONTATION]

Where it sits: [BEAT NUMBER AND CHAPTER FROM PROMPT 14]

Design the sequence:

1. THE OBJECTIVE: what each side is actually trying to achieve. Not 'win' - a specific, losable objective, plus what each will settle for.
2. THE GEOMETRY: the physical situation - distances, timescale, what can be detected and when, what the terrain or orbital mechanics do to the options. Work strictly within my doctrine from Prompt 7.
3. THE PLAN AND ITS ASSUMPTION: my side's approach, who executes what, and the one assumption everything rests on.
4. THE TURN: how the assumption proves wrong, in two stages - a first shock that is

absorbed, then the real one.

5. THE BEATS: 12-16 sequential beats, one sentence each, with the clock noted every few beats - fuel, time to intercept, remaining ordnance, casualties, air, whatever my situation runs on.

6. THE HUMAN SCALE: 3 moments inside this sequence experienced by one named person at arm's length - what they see, hear, smell and do. These are what the reader remembers, not the tactics.

7. THE COST: what is permanently lost - ships, people, a position, a reputation, a relationship - and who has to report it to whom afterwards.

8. THE AFTER: the quiet scene that follows and the one line spoken in it that changes a relationship.

End by asking me whether the objective at item 1 was achieved, because a sequence where my side wins the fight and loses the objective is the strongest version of this scene.

Pro Tip: Write item 6 first. Fleet actions become abstract the moment they leave a body, and three grounded arm's-length moments will carry a forty-page engagement that no amount of tactical clarity can save.

PROMPT 16 of 22

Braiding the Viewpoints

Multiple threads are how space opera covers a galaxy - and how it loses readers. This prompt orders your viewpoints, balances their page time, and keeps every thread earning its place.

✂ **COPY THIS PROMPT:**

You are a structural editor who specialises in multi-viewpoint novels.

My viewpoint characters and rotation plan: [PASTE FROM PROMPT 10 ITEM 7]

My beat sheet: [PASTE FROM PROMPT 14]

My locations: [FROM PROMPT 2]

Build my BRAID:

1. THE THREAD AUDIT: for each viewpoint, state its own arc in one sentence, what information only it can deliver, and what the book would lose if I cut it.

Recommend cutting or merging any thread that fails this test.

2. THE PAGE SHARE: recommend a percentage of the book for each thread, and warn me which one I will over-write and which I will neglect.

3. THE INTERLEAVE: propose a chapter-by-chapter viewpoint order for the first quarter, and the rule I should follow for the rest - never two consecutive chapters in the same thread at high tension, always cut away on a hook, and so on. State my rules explicitly.

4. THE CONVERGENCE POINTS: name the 3 places where threads meet, and what each meeting changes. Threads that never meet are a different book.

5. THE INFORMATION LADDER: track what each viewpoint knows that the others do not, and mark the two places where the reader knows more than a character - the genre's most reliable source of dread.

6. THE ORIENTATION KIT: how each chapter re-establishes viewpoint, place and time within its first three lines without a header dump. Give me two sample openings per thread.

7. THE DROPPED THREAD CHECK: identify any thread absent for more than four chapters and tell me how to bridge the gap.

End by asking me which thread I would cut if my editor demanded 20,000 words gone, because knowing that now will make the draft cleaner.

Pro Tip: Answer the closing question honestly and then consider cutting that thread before you draft it. The thread you would sacrifice under pressure is almost always the one you were writing out of worldbuilding enthusiasm rather than story need.

PHASE 5: WRITE THE BOOK

Structure becomes prose. These three prompts turn your braid into a chapter plan, draft an opening that delivers scale through one person, and give you a reusable engine for drafting in batches while holding voice, viewpoint discipline and galactic continuity steady.

PROMPT 17 of 22

Chapter Outline with Hooks

This prompt converts your beat sheet and braid into a chapter-by-chapter plan where every chapter has a viewpoint, a job, a turn and a hook.

✂ COPY THIS PROMPT:

You are a novel outliner working in multi-viewpoint science fiction.

My beat sheet: [PASTE FROM PROMPT 14]

My braid rules and interleave: [PASTE FROM PROMPT 16]

My set pieces: [LIST THOSE DESIGNED WITH PROMPT 15]

Target: [E.G. 120,000 WORDS IN 55 CHAPTERS OF ABOUT 2,200 WORDS]

Build my CHAPTER OUTLINE. For every chapter give me:

1. Chapter number and working title.
2. Viewpoint character, location, and elapsed time since that thread's last chapter.
3. The chapter's job in one sentence.
4. The turn: what is true at the end that was not true at the start.
5. Which thread it serves - galactic, personal, or both.
6. The closing hook, as a one-line description.

Then flag: any chapter that only conveys information, any three consecutive chapters serving only the galactic thread, any thread absent for more than four

chapters, any chapter where the viewpoint character is a spectator to their own scene, and any place two set pieces sit too close together.

End by asking me which chapter I am least able to justify, so we can cut or combine it before I write 2,200 words I will delete.

Pro Tip: Watch for the spectator flag. In big-canvas fiction it is easy to write a viewpoint character who watches history happen; if they cannot affect the scene, either give them agency in it or hand the chapter to someone who has some.

PROMPT 18 of 22

The Opening Chapter

This prompt drafts chapter one so that it delivers competence, world and scale through one person doing one job - the genre's hardest and most important opening move.

✂ COPY THIS PROMPT:

You are a novelist drafting the opening chapter of a space opera in the voice described below.

My voice essentials: [PASTE THE VOICE LIST FROM THIS PACK'S CHEAT SHEET, PLUS NOTES ON YOUR OWN STYLE]

My protagonist and their small life: [PASTE FROM PROMPT 9]

Life aboard and the personal scale of technology: [PASTE FROM PROMPT 7 ITEMS 2 AND 7]

My faction voices: [FROM PROMPT 5 ITEM 7]

POV and tense: [SPECIFY]

Target length: [E.G. 2,500-3,000 WORDS]

Write chapter one, following these rules:

1. Open with my protagonist performing their duty competently, mid-task.
2. Establish their competence by showing them solve one small professional problem.
3. Deliver the physical reality of this world through the body - gravity, air, noise, temperature, the feel of the equipment.
4. Let the galaxy exist only as background: a routine mention of distance, a faction name, a transit time, a piece of news that is not yet about them.
5. Use faction and service vocabulary in context, explaining nothing.
6. Include the three ordinary details from Prompt 9 item 8, placed so they seem incidental.
7. Deliver exactly one moment of genuine wonder, at arm's length and through the senses.
8. End on the hook from my chapter outline.

After the chapter, list what a reader can infer about the galaxy from it, and flag anything I explained that I should have implied.

End by asking me whether a reader who stopped here would want to spend four hundred

more pages with this person, and what specifically would make them want to.

Pro Tip: Keep the wonder to one moment. A first chapter that gasps at everything teaches the reader to skim the descriptions, and by the time you reach the thing you actually wanted them to marvel at, they have stopped looking.

PROMPT 19 of 22

The Batch Drafting Engine

The prompt you will reuse most. It drafts three to five chapters at a time while holding voice, viewpoint discipline, travel-rule consistency and the state of the war.

✂ **COPY THIS PROMPT:**

You are my drafting partner on a space opera novel. You write in my established voice and hand control back to me at the end of every batch.

STANDING CONTEXT (reuse and update this block every batch):

- Voice sample: [PASTE 300-500 WORDS OF YOUR APPROVED CHAPTER ONE FROM PROMPT 18]
- Viewpoint characters and their current arc stage: [LIST]
- Ensemble status: [WHO IS ALIVE, WHO IS ABOARD, WHO IS INJURED, WHO IS ESTRANGED]
- Ship and fleet status: [DAMAGE, SUPPLIES, FUEL, ORDNANCE, CREW LOSSES]
- The war: [WHO HOLDS WHAT, WHAT HAPPENED LAST, WHAT EACH POWER BELIEVES]
- Travel and communication rules I must not break: [THE FIVE CONSTRAINTS FROM PROMPT 4]
- Information ladder: [WHAT EACH VIEWPOINT KNOWS THAT THE OTHERS DO NOT, FROM PROMPT 16]
- Elapsed time and current date: [STATE IT]

THIS BATCH: write chapters [X] to [Y] from my outline:
[PASTE THE OUTLINE ENTRIES FROM PROMPT 17]

Rules for this batch:

1. Match the voice sample in rhythm, sentence length and level of interiority.
2. Never let information travel faster than my communication rules allow.
3. Every chapter must change something in the standing context.
4. Faction characters speak in their own register; service characters use procedure and shorthand.
5. Ground every large-scale event in one body in one room.
6. Re-establish viewpoint, place and time in the first three lines without a header dump.
7. End each chapter on its outlined hook.

After the chapters, give me a STATUS REPORT: elapsed time, ship and fleet condition, casualties, who now knows what, and any promise you made on the page that I owe the reader.

End by asking me which chapter drifted furthest from my voice, so the next batch does not inherit the drift.

Pro Tip: Update the information ladder every single batch. Nothing unravels a multi-viewpoint space opera faster than a character reacting to news that, under your own communication rules, is still six days from reaching them.

PHASE 6: POLISH, PUBLISH, EXPAND

The last three prompts protect your reviews and build what follows: an audit of scale, logistics and continuity, a voice pass that rations wonder and sharpens the enormous, and a combined publishing and multi-book series kit.

PROMPT 20 of 22

Scale, Logistics and Continuity Audit

This genre's readers check your distances, your fuel and your timelines. This prompt finds the breaches before a reviewer does.

✂ COPY THIS PROMPT:

You are a continuity editor who specialises in large-canvas science fiction and who is merciless about travel times, supply lines and information lag.

My travel and communication constraints: [PASTE FROM PROMPT 4]

My combat doctrine and the cost of war: [PASTE FROM PROMPT 7]

My powers and their economies: [PASTE FROM PROMPT 5]

My stakes ceiling: [FROM PROMPT 2]

My manuscript or detailed chapter summaries: [PASTE - WORK IN SECTIONS IF LONG]

Audit for the following, citing the chapter for every issue:

1. TRAVEL TIMES: every journey measured against my own constraints. Flag anything that arrives too conveniently.
2. INFORMATION LAG: every place a character knows something before my communication rules would allow.
3. LOGISTICS: fuel, ordnance, food, spare hulls, trained crew replacement. Where does a fleet operate on supplies it does not have?
4. COMBAT CONSISTENCY: does every engagement obey the doctrine and timescale I set, or do battles change speed to suit the scene?
5. STAKES CREEP: mark any point where the threatened scale exceeds the ceiling I set in Prompt 2, and tell me the cost of leaving it in.
6. CAST TRACKING: who is where, who is alive, who has been off-page too long, and any character acting on knowledge they do not have.
7. THE ECONOMY CHECK: does anyone in this book eat, get paid, and get replaced? Flag where the galaxy runs on nothing.
8. NAME COLLISION: flag any names, places or ships too similar to tell apart at speed.

Rank findings CRITICAL, MODERATE or MINOR, with a fix for every CRITICAL item.

End by asking me which critical fix would require a structural change, so I can

plan that repair before touching the prose.

Pro Tip: Run item 8 before you finish drafting, not after. Two captains named Vey and Vela is a problem you can fix in an afternoon at chapter twenty and a nightmare to untangle at chapter fifty-five.

PROMPT 21 of 22

The Wonder and Voice Pass

This prompt tunes prose at the line level for the genre's specific demand: making the enormous felt, keeping competence readable, and rationing awe so it still works late in the book.

✂ COPY THIS PROMPT:

You are a line editor working on epic science fiction.

My voice essentials: [PASTE THE VOICE LIST FROM THIS PACK'S CHEAT SHEET]
Chapter to edit: [PASTE ONE CHAPTER]

Do a line-level pass:

1. THE SCALE TEST: find every place I state size, distance or quantity in numbers, and propose a comparison, sensation or consequence that would land harder.
2. THE WONDER BUDGET: identify every moment of awe in this chapter. If there is more than one, tell me which to keep and demote the rest to plain description.
3. THE BODY CHECK: mark places where a large event is described from nowhere, and show me how to anchor it in one character's physical experience.
4. COMPETENCE REGISTER: check that professionals speak in procedure and shorthand rather than explaining their jobs to each other. Rewrite the worst offender.
5. FACTION VOICE: flag any character speaking in generic register rather than their own faction's, using my faction voices from Prompt 5.
6. RHYTHM MAP: check that sentences tighten in vacuum and combat and open up planetside and in council. Show me one rewritten paragraph.
7. THE ABSTRACTION HUNT: find general nouns - the fleet, the enemy, the system, the council - where a specific name from my world would land harder.
8. INFODUMP SWEEP: find every passage where the narrative explains politics or history, and propose how to deliver it as friction between characters instead.

Return edits as a list - original line, proposed line, one-line reason. Do not rewrite the chapter.

End by asking me which of your changes I rejected, so you can calibrate to my voice for the next chapter.

Pro Tip: The wonder budget is the single most useful discipline in this pack. Three astonishments per book, placed at the quarter marks, will do more for a reader than thirty - and the ones you cut become ordinary description that makes the kept ones enormous.

PROMPT 22 of 22

Blurb, Metadata and Series Architecture

The combined publishing and series kit - retail copy, categories, cover brief, and the multi-book architecture this genre almost always requires.

✂ COPY THIS PROMPT:

You are a book marketing copywriter and series architect for adult science fiction.

My reader promise and pitches: [PASTE FROM PROMPT 3]
My premise, protagonist and hinge: [PASTE FROM PROMPTS 1 AND 9]
My beat sheet and ending: [PASTE FROM PROMPT 14]
My stakes ceiling: [FROM PROMPT 2]
My surviving cast and unresolved threads: [LIST]

PART A - THE RETAIL KIT:

1. THE BLURB: 150-200 words in three movements - the galaxy and its flashpoint in two sentences, my protagonist and their impossible position, the stakes and hook. Nothing past the midpoint. Lead with the person, not the empire.
2. TWO ALTERNATIVES: a punchy 100-word version, and one that leads with the crew.
3. THE HOOK LINE: three options for the line above the blurb.
4. CATEGORIES: 6 retail categories ranked by how well I compete in each.
5. KEYWORDS: 20 reader-search phrases grouped into trope, mood and situation terms.
6. COMP POSITIONING: 4 comparable reading experiences described as types of book, each with a 'for readers who loved X but wanted Y' line.
7. THE COVER BRIEF: 5 visual directions tied to specific images from my book, and 3 cover clichés to forbid.

PART B - THE SERIES:

8. THE SHAPE: recommend a series shape - a trilogy with one escalating war, an open-ended crew series, or a generational mosaic across the same galaxy - and justify it against my ending and my stakes ceiling.
9. THE SERIES QUESTION: the question the whole series answers, distinct from book one's.
10. THE ESCALATION RULE: what grows across books and what must stay intimate. Confirm the series never exceeds the ceiling from Prompt 2, and say what I escalate instead of scale.
11. BOOK TWO: a one-page premise - the new pressure, the returning cost from book one, and a hook in the first three chapters. It must not undo book one's ending.
12. THE SEEDS: 6 things planted or plantable in book one that pay off later - a character, a world, a debt, a technology, an unanswered question, a survivor.
13. THE STANDALONE GUARANTEE: confirm book one satisfies alone, and name anything in my ending that reads as an unpaid promise rather than an open door.

End by asking me which promise in the blurb I am least confident the book delivers, so we can fix the blurb or fix the book.

Pro Tip: Item 10 is what keeps a series alive past book two. When scale cannot grow, escalate intimacy instead - move the war closer to the people the reader already loves, and the stakes will feel larger while the numbers stay the same.

Space opera is the only genre that asks you to hold a galaxy and a single face in the same sentence. Every technique in this pack exists to serve that one trick. The travel rules from Prompt 4 are there so distance can hurt someone. The faction economies from Prompt 5 are there so a supply decision can starve a character you love. The wonder discipline in Prompt 21 is there so the astonishing moments still astonish on page four hundred. When a chapter feels weightless, the fault is almost always the same: the galactic event has drifted loose from the person it should be happening to. Tie it back to one body in one room and the scale returns. Now go finish the book - the fleets are waiting, and so is the person they are going to cost.

Royalti Studios

The galaxy is the stage. The book is about the people small enough to be crushed by it - and who are not.

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